and certificates. This is also the format that the ingress controller needs. To make the key and certificate available to the ingress, you need to create a *Kubernetes secret* to hold them.

> DEFINITION ***Kubernetes secrets*** are a standard mechanism for distributing passwords, keys, and other credentials to pods running in a cluster. The secrets are stored in a central database and distributed to pods as either filesystem mounts or environment variables. You'll learn more about Kubernetes secrets in chapter 11.

To make the certificate available to the ingress, run the following command:

```
kubectl create secret tls natter-tls -n natter-api \
  --key=api.natter.local-key.pem --cert=api.natter.local.pem
```

This will create a TLS secret with the name `natter-tls` in the `natter-api` namespace with the given key and certificate files. The ingress controller will be able to find this secret because of the `secretName` configuration option in the ingress configuration file. You can now create the ingress configuration to expose the Natter API to external clients:

```
kubectl apply -f kubernetes/natter-ingress.yaml
```

You'll now be able to make direct HTTPS calls to the API: